

1

Education and employment

1.1 ISSUES IN EDUCATION

IN THIS UNIT

GRAMMAR

- the continuous aspect
- the perfect aspect

VOCABULARY

- issues in education
- reporting what others say
- suffixes (adjectives)
- abbreviations

SCENARIO

- stating requirements, saying what is essential and desirable
- choosing an intern

STUDY SKILLS

- self-awareness

WRITING SKILLS

- a covering letter



Education costs money, but then so does ignorance. Claus Moser (b. 1922), German-born British academic



SPEAKING AND VOCABULARY

1a Complete the opinions with the words in the box.

assessment curriculum dumbing down elitism
interpersonal skills plagiarism streaming

- 1 'The most important aspect of education is the _____, or subjects which are taught.'
- 2 'Frequent examinations are a much more reliable and useful way of measuring performance than continuous _____.'
- 3 '_____ is an excellent idea because it enables students with a similar ability to work at the same pace.'
- 4 'Education is not about developing your _____, but about learning facts.'
- 5 'Private education creates _____ and encourages inequality in society, which is absolutely disgusting.'
- 6 'Copying someone else's ideas, _____, cheating and buying qualifications is sometimes necessary.'
- 7 'It's easier to get good grades nowadays because education is _____. Qualifications are worth less than in the past.'

1b Which opinions do you agree or disagree with? Work with a partner and discuss your ideas.

2 Work with a partner and discuss the following.

- 1 the advantages and disadvantages of your country's education system
- 2 the positive and negative aspects of your own educational experiences

READING

3 Which of the following are important to learn at school?

- 1 important dates in history, e.g. battles
- 2 the names of capital cities
- 3 times tables, e.g. $4 \times 7 = 28$
- 4 scientific formulae, e.g. $E = mc^2$
- 5 spelling
- 6 mental arithmetic, e.g. adding up numbers in your head
- 7 poems and excerpts from literature

4 What techniques do you have for learning any of the above? Tell a partner.

5 What do you understand by the term 'rote learning'? Scan the article to check your answer.

6 Read the article. In which paragraph does the writer:

- 1 **argue** that it is pointless to memorise significant historical facts?
- 2 **claim** that rote learning is often used by professionals?
- 3 **comment** that there is an educational split in the world?
- 4 **conclude** that putting knowledge into practice is the most important thing?
- 5 **deny** that there are no positive aspects to rote learning?
- 6 **point out** that rote learning is considered old-fashioned?
- 7 **suggest** that learning alone is often boring?

7 Is the writer positive, negative or undecided about rote learning? Do you agree with the writer? Why?/ Why not?

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Learning by rote in the digital age

When it comes to education, there's a divide between East and West. Eastern nations' education systems have historically favoured rote learning – that is, memorisation – compared with Western schooling, which often cites creativity and innovation as key goals of a rounded education. Rote learning has become seen as an antiquated method of teaching. The dictionary defines learning 'by rote' as: 'from memory, without thought of the meaning; in a mechanical way'.

The decline of rote learning in the West has been facilitated by technology. No one needs to memorise friends' phone numbers or email addresses because such data is conveniently stored and accessible electronically – our phones have become databases, while the internet can answer any question to which there exists an answer. So why remember the date of the Treaty of Versailles when you can find the answer on Google in about six seconds? But now there are rumblings in the UK of a need to return to rote learning, which has stirred controversy in the media. You'd be forgiven for thinking the whole thing was a terrible idea. But there are benefits to memorising stuff.

In fact, memorising key data is fundamental to learning any skill. Doctoring requires knowledge of the anatomy, lawyering requires knowledge of cases and statutes, learning languages requires

grammar and even new alphabets in some cases. Of course, being able to recall things will not further your understanding of those things, but without memorising these foundation elements, you cannot progress to a deeper understanding of a subject.

While the internet and computers have undermined the need for us to remember things, it may well be that mobile learning can help revive this style of learning by making it more convenient, more accessible and more fun.

Drilling yourself – with flashcards or by brute repetition – is hard work (and usually tedious), which is why most people need their multiplication tables to be drilled into them by teachers or parents. Rote learning without a willing third party can be a battle of discipline and motivation. But mobile learning can make those flashcards and drills more appropriate to individual study; our devices can challenge and inform us at the same time and also keep us motivated, whether through game-like structures or recording our progress.

Learning by rote does have limited use. Once you've acquired the fundamentals of a subject, the need to memorise data usually diminishes and it becomes the application of knowledge which is important.

VOCABULARY

REPORTING WHAT OTHERS SAY

8 Match the verbs in bold in Exercise 6 with their meanings.

- a say that something is not true
- b make a point strongly, giving reasons/evidence
- c decide that something is true after consideration
- d express an opinion
- e state that something is true
- f put forward an idea in a tentative way
- g bring to the reader's attention

LISTENING

9a **1.1** Listen to three people on a radio programme talking about the purpose of education. Where are they from and what do they do?

9b Listen again and make notes on the speakers' views.

- 1 How do their opinions differ?
- 2 What suggestions do they make?
- 3 Who is the most persuasive speaker? Why?

9c Compare your notes with a partner.

10 **Reacting to the text** Work in small groups and discuss the questions.

- 1 What is your reaction to the views you heard on the radio programme? How common do you think they are?
- 2 Which is closest to the view of the writer?
- 3 Which is closest to the view of the writer of the article in Exercise 6?
- 3 What similarities are there between the views expressed on the radio programme and the education system in your country?

SPEAKING

11 Work in small groups and discuss the statements and questions.

- 1 'You get what you pay for.' Do you think this is true for education in your country?
- 2 Males and females should be educated separately.
- 3 What do you think are the key goals of education?
- 4 What are the advantages and disadvantages of school uniforms?

12 Work with a student from another group. Tell him/her about your group's ideas. Listen and make notes on what he/she tells you.

13 Report back to your group about what the student told you in Exercise 12, using your notes. Are the ideas similar or different to your group's ideas?

SPEAKING

1a Think of three successful people in these fields: business, the arts, science. Why do you think they are successful (e.g. education, hard work, talent, good luck)? Tell a partner.

1b Which qualities do the people you described share?

READING



2 Read the profiles of three successful people quickly. In what way are they successful?



3 Look at some common characteristics of successful people. Which of them apply to the people you read about?

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| 1 hard-working | 4 creative |
| 2 innovative | 5 business-minded |
| 3 highly educated | 6 self-disciplined |

4 Read the profiles again and answer the questions.

- What do you think of Nooyi's management style?
- How do you think Kim's earlier career could have helped her achieve her later success?
- What difficulties did Greider have to overcome and how did she do so?
- Which of the three people are you most impressed by? Tell a partner.

VOCABULARY

SUFFIXES (ADJECTIVES)

5a Find adjectives in the profiles which are formed from the nouns in the box.

allergy	infection	influence
passion	persuasion	power success

5b What suffixes are used to form these adjectives?

allergy – *allergic*

6a Make adjectives from the nouns in the box. Use the correct suffixes.

affection	ambition	education
empathy	fiction	logic speculation

6b Answer the questions.

- Who is the most successful person you know? Give reasons.
- Who is your favourite fictional character? Why?
- What is the most powerful piece of art or film that you have seen?
- What educational background is needed to become a teacher in your country?

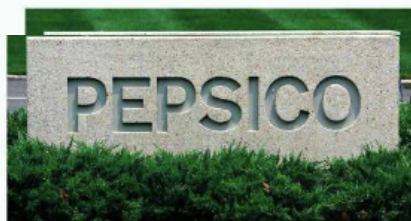
Indra Nooyi

In 2010 Indra Nooyi was named the most powerful businesswoman in the world by *Fortune* magazine. She has been working as Chairperson and Chief Executive Officer of PepsiCo since 2006. Born in India, she has a Bachelor of Science degree, an MBA from the Indian Institute of Management and a Master's degree in Public and Private Management from Yale University.

Nooyi has a reputation for being very persuasive and has the ability to rouse an audience. She also has a very informal style in meetings and openly solicits the opinions of her staff. At one investors' conference, Nooyi sat down with the delegates and conducted the business equivalent of a fireside chat.

Nooyi is constantly reinventing her business model. 'The minute you've decided a new business model, it's extinct because somebody is going to copy it.' For years she's been talking about the importance of healthier products and education about nutrition.

She works 18–20 hours a day and is currently serving on the board of several organisations.



Angela Jia Kim

Angela Jia Kim is a successful entrepreneur, having already founded two companies.

Her first piano teacher was her mother and later she graduated from the Eastman School of Music.

Her classical refinement and passionate performances have delighted audiences worldwide.

One day just as she was about to perform on stage, she had an allergic reaction to a body lotion. As a result of this, she decided to develop her own line of skincare products. 'I was paying attention to what I was eating,' she says. 'Shouldn't I pay attention to what I was putting on my body?' She started experimenting to find non-toxic creams and eventually launched Om Aroma & Co., an organic skincare line.





Carol Greider

Carol Greider won the Nobel Prize in Medicine in 2009 after making a breakthrough in DNA and cancer research. However, Carol struggled at elementary school. She found it difficult to pronounce words and to read out loud. She was put into remedial spelling class and this led to

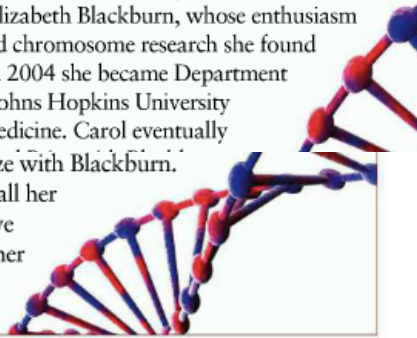
problems with self-esteem. She thought of herself as stupid until she was diagnosed with dyslexia.

She had to memorise words to spell them, but then began to enjoy reading for pleasure. Then she found it easy to remember things in Biology and History. She enjoyed working hard. However, she still struggled to get into graduate school and received many rejection letters due to poor scores in the Graduate Recorded Exam.

Eventually, she was offered a place by the California Institute of Technology and UC Berkeley. She chose UC Berkeley as she wanted to work with Elizabeth Blackburn, whose enthusiasm for DNA and chromosome research she found infectious. In 2004 she became Department Director at Johns Hopkins University School of Medicine. Carol eventually

won the Nobel Prize with Blackburn.

She always credits all her colleagues who have been influential in her scientific journey.



Her degree was in Music, not Business, so she sought advice from respected businesswomen who were going through similar experiences.

She went on to create Savor the Success, an online community for female entrepreneurs.

She says her success in business is due to her training as a concert pianist and, of course, hard work.



GRAMMAR

THE CONTINUOUS ASPECT

7a Read the profiles of Indra Nooyi and Angela Jia Kim again and find examples of these tenses.

- 1 present continuous
- 2 past continuous
- 3 present perfect continuous

7b Which of the tenses you found are used to talk about:

- 1 an action that was in progress at an earlier time?
- 2 an action that is currently in progress?
- 3 an action which began in the past and is still continuing or has just finished?

➔ Language reference and extra practice, pages 126–127

8 Explain the difference in meaning between the sentences in each pair.

- 1 a I work in Madrid, but I live in a village forty kilometres away.
b I'm working in Madrid, but I'm moving to Barcelona next year.
- 2 a I've worked in London, Paris and Rome, but now I work in Tokyo.
b I've been working in Tokyo for a year and expect to continue to do so for some time.
- 3 a I worked in Oslo in 2013.
b I was working in Oslo when my father fell ill.
- 4 a I'll work when you get home if you look after the children.
b I'll be working when you get home, so please try to keep quiet.
- 5 a When her car broke down, she was driving to Moscow for a conference.
b When her car broke down, she went the rest of the way by bus.
- 6 a We are renting an apartment until our house is ready.
b We rent an apartment by the sea most summers.

9 Correct the mistakes in the use of tenses in the text.

I really respect my best friend. He ^{comes} is coming from Poland and is speaking four languages. He is living in London since 1998 and I've been knowing him for ten years. We met on holiday when we hitchhike through Spain. One day while we walk through the Cantabrian Mountains, he told me that even though he had been leaving school at fifteen, he was going to be very successful. He joined his company when it is having difficulties. He was working his way up to the top since then. He is only working there for seven years and he is already being the Director.

WRITING

10 Justifying opinions Write a short paragraph giving and justifying your opinion on one of these statements.

- 1 A good education is the key to a successful life.
- 2 Luck and family connections are more important than a good education.
- 3 Success is ten percent inspiration and ninety percent perspiration.

SPEAKING

1 Work in small groups and discuss the questions.

- 1 How do you find out about jobs in your country?
- 2 What jobs have you had/would you like to have?
- 3 Have you ever written a CV/résumé? When?
- 4 Is there a standard format for CVs/résumés in your country?

READING

2 Which of the following do you think are essential to mention in your CV?

- 1 website addresses of companies you have worked for
- 2 details of pre-university qualifications
- 3 a photograph
- 4 date of birth
- 5 postal address
- 6 telephone number and email address
- 7 names of referees
- 8 internships/work placements
- 9 software used
- 10 charity work
- 11 interests
- 12 positions of responsibility
- 13 title, e.g. Mr/Miss/Ms
- 14 achievements
- 15 interpersonal skills

2a Evaluating effectiveness Read Vadim

3a Evaluating effectiveness Read Vadim Kufenko's CV quickly. Do you think it is a good CV? Is there anything you would do differently?

3b Read the CV again and answer the questions.

- 1 What do you notice about the way the profile is written?
- 2 Which exchange programme might he have found the most difficult? Why?
- 3 What kinds of job do you think he might be suitable for?

4 Vadim is applying for a job in the marketing department of a British company that exports British products to Russia. They require a fluent Russian speaker, with advanced English and experience in finance and marketing. Rewrite Vadim's profile to help him get this job.

CV

Name: Vadim Kufenko

Date of birth: 8 May 1986

Email address: kufenko.vadim3@online.ru

PROFILE

An enthusiastic and dedicated professional with excellent analytical abilities in the field of finance. Exceptional numerical skills. Quick to grasp new ideas and concepts and able to work on his own initiative. Has a logical approach to challenges and is able to meet tight deadlines. Strong project management skills. A good team player with outstanding interpersonal skills.

WORK EXPERIENCE

December 2008–October 2013

Financial Analyst at the Bank of Foreign Trade, St Petersburg.
Responsibilities: daily financial analysis, preparing financial statements, data processing and marketing surveys

EDUCATION

December 2013–present

PhD in Economics and Finance, St Petersburg State University of Economics and Finance

September 2007–July 2008

MA in Economics, specialising in Finance and Credit, St Petersburg State University of Economics and Finance

September 2003–June 2007

BA in Economics, St Petersburg State University of Economics and Finance

1998–1999

Southwest Junior High School, Lawrence, Kansas, USA

Southwest Junior High School, Lawrence, Kansas, USA

1993–2003

School #157, St Petersburg

INTERNSHIPS AND EXCHANGE PROGRAMMES

September–December 2007

Exchange programme at the University of Jyväskylä, Finland
Programmes: Finance, Business Networks, Family Business, Marketing (in English), Finnish language

April 2007

Short internship at the Bank of Foreign Trade, St Petersburg

April–July 2006

Exchange programme at the Berlin School of Economics, Germany
Programmes (in German): International Economic Relations, International Marketing, German language

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages: English (advanced IELTS 8.0, BULATS), German (intermediate), Finnish (elementary)

HOBBIES

Trading in stocks and shares, swimming and jogging





VOCABULARY

ABBREVIATIONS



5 Work in small groups and match the abbreviations with the descriptions.

- | | | | |
|-------|-------|----------|---------|
| 1 PhD | 3 MBA | 5 BULATS | 7 TOEFL |
| 2 MSc | 4 BA | 6 IELTS | |

- a a first degree in the Humanities
- b a postgraduate degree in a science subject
- c a postgraduate degree, which entitles the holder to the title *Dr*
- d a postgraduate business qualification
- e a qualification in Business English
- f a test of reading, writing, listening and speaking, often used by British and Australian universities
- g a test of comprehension in written and spoken English, often used by American universities

LISTENING

6a 1.2 Listen to part of Vadim's job interview and answer the questions.

- Why does the interviewer mention when the interview will finish?
- What regret does Vadim mention?
- What advice does the interviewer give Vadim?
- How does Vadim turn a possible weakness into a strength?
- Why does Vadim want the advertised job?
- What mistake does the interviewer make?

6b Listen again and evaluate the interview. Answer the questions.

- Do you think what Vadim said highlights his strengths?
- How would you describe the interviewer's attitude towards Vadim?
- How do you think the interview is going so far?

GRAMMAR

THE PERFECT ASPECT

7 Look at Audio script 1.2 on page 165 and find examples of the following.

- present perfect simple
- present perfect continuous
- past perfect
- future perfect
- perfect infinitive
- having + past participle

8 The perfect aspect links two times together. Which two times (present, past or future) are being linked together in each sentence?

- Hopefully, we'll have finished the interview by 3 p.m.
- I'd applied for a number of work placements before I got the one in the bank.
- I've been on two exchange programmes: one in Finland and one in Germany.
- Having read your CV, we'd like to know more about your internship and exchange programmes.
- I seem to have lost your references.
- Since December 2013 I've been writing my doctoral thesis.

➔ Language reference and extra practice, pages 126–127

9 Complete the sentences with the correct perfect form of the verbs in brackets.

- I intended to come for just a couple of months, but next September I _____ (be) here for five years.
- When I interviewed him, he _____ (already/be) out of work for over a year.
- My sister _____ (be) the head of a PR company for the last ten years.
- We _____ (interview) five people since 9 a.m., but I don't think any of them meet the requirements.
- It's no use sending your CV now. They _____ (choose) a candidate by the end of today.
- I was hoping _____ (finish) by now.
- _____ (complete) my training, I am now looking for a job in finance.

WRITING

10a Choose a job that you would like to be interviewed for. Write a short CV to help you get the job.

10b Swap CVs with a partner and tell each other what jobs they are for. Suggest improvements to your partner's CV.



MEET THE EXPERT

Watch an interview with Helen Kempster, a careers consultant, about job hunting and interviews.

Turn to page 150 for video activities.

SITUATION

Anderson University is a private university in the United Kingdom. Many of its students want to do internships of three to six months with companies or international organisations. They generally pay a fee and use the services of Morton Associates, a firm that specialises in arranging internships. Morton Associates is looking for a suitable candidate for an internship with the international organisation UNESCO.

1a Read the situation, the description of UNESCO and the duties of the intern.

1b Work in pairs or small groups and discuss what kind of person would be suitable for this internship. Think about the candidate's educational qualifications, personal qualities, experience, skills and interests.

2 Discuss your profile of the ideal candidate with another pair or group.



3 1.3 Listen to Lisa and Howard, two members of Morton Associates, talking about the requirements for candidates applying for an internship at UNESCO. Work with a partner and make notes under these headings.

- Qualifications
- Languages
- Work experience
- Computer skills
- Interests

KEY LANGUAGE

STATING REQUIREMENTS, SAYING WHAT IS ESSENTIAL AND DESIRABLE

4 Read the extracts in Exercise 5 and try to predict what words are missing.

5 1.4 Listen to extracts from the conversation in Exercise 3 and complete the gaps. Do not use more than two words for each gap.

- 1 L: It's _____ that candidates are doing a postgraduate degree.
- 2 H: What about languages?
L: Well, they _____ an excellent knowledge of one of the working languages of the organisation – that means really good English or French, oral and written.
H: Right, so that's _____.
- 3 H: How about work experience?
L: Well, they don't mention that specifically, but it's obviously _____ to have some work experience.
- 4 H: You haven't mentioned computer skills.
L: Well, candidates _____ to be able to use office-related software.
- 5 H: Anything else?
L: No, but we'll be _____ some evidence of a special cultural or scientific interest.

6 Look at Audio script 1.3 on page 165. Underline all the phrases which are used to state requirements, and say whether each one is essential or desirable.

UNESCO activities



UNESCO promotes international cooperation among its 195 Member States and eight Associate Members in the fields of education, science, culture and communication. It has a wide range of programmes, which will appeal to students from diverse disciplines.

Aims:

- to mobilise for education so that every child, boy or girl, has access to education as a fundamental human right
- to build international understanding through protection of heritage and support for cultural diversity
- to pursue scientific cooperation
- to protect freedom of expression

Duties of the intern

- to assist in administrative duties as assigned by the director
- to assist in the research and writing of department publications
- to assist with the creation of PowerPoint presentations and maintenance of databases
- to help coordinate special events and conferences
- to take part in the development of student educational programmes

TASK

CHOOSING AN INTERN

7a Work in groups of three. You are members of Morton Associates. You are going to recommend one intern for the internship at UNESCO. There is only one vacancy at the moment. Read the profiles and underline the strong points of each candidate. Make a note of any points you think the candidate lacks.

Student A: read the profile of Pilar Martinez.

Student B: read the profile of Anette Frieberg.

Student C: read the profile of Kenneth Watana.

7b In your groups, discuss the candidates. Talk about their strengths and weaknesses and why they should/shouldn't get the internship.

7c Rank the candidates in order of their suitability for the internship (1 = most suitable, 3 = least suitable).

7d Choose the best candidate to recommend for the internship. Then compare your choice with other groups.

Profile

Qualifications
Final year PhD in Fine Art

Languages
Fluent Spanish, intermediate level English and French

Computer skills
Basic knowledge of office programs and software

Experience
Holiday work with a picture restorer at National Museum of Art

Attitude
Very articulate. Passionate about art conservation. Not at all interested in current affairs. Seemed rather naïve and unsophisticated about world affairs. Has travelled all over the world. Made interesting comments about cross-cultural problems.

Other information
Dressed fashionably. Recommendation from art professor: 'Pilar is single-minded. Art is her life. She is open to new ideas – that's her best quality.' Wants to work in picture conservation all over the world after she graduates.



Pilar Martinez

Profile

Qualifications
Final year PhD. Topic: language policies in Swedish schools

Languages
Bilingual English–Swedish

Computer skills
Extensive knowledge of computer programs and software

Experience
Worked during two summers for a 'travel by teaching' organisation. Gained a good knowledge of Asian cultures.

Attitude
An extrovert. Seemed extremely confident. Expressed her opinions on social issues forcefully. Possibly not very open-minded. She didn't appear to be a good listener.

Other information
Dressed rather casually for the interview. Recommendation from a lecturer: 'Anette's greatest strength is as a team leader. She expects a lot from members of her team.' Is President of the University International Society. Would like to work for an organisation which promotes women's and children's rights.



Anette Frieberg

Profile

Qualifications
Final year MA in Museum and Artefact Studies

Languages
Thai, fairly good English and French (upper-intermediate level). Is learning German in evening class.

Computer skills
Competent using common software programs

Experience
One-month part-time work at a local Railway Museum. Visitor information, communication with public.

Attitude
Quiet, reflective person. Hesitated frequently before answering questions. Extremely polite during the interview. Seemed unwilling to give his views on current affairs.

Other information
Smart appearance. Is editor of the university newspaper. Also active in the Drama Society – recently gave talk on Asian Theatre and Rituals. Recommendation from tutor: 'James is a team player rather than a leader. He has exceptional research skills.' Very interested in underwater cultural heritage and social media. His hobby is snorkelling. Goes to Turkey every summer to do some snorkelling.



Kenneth Watana

USEFUL PHRASES

Talking about strengths and weaknesses

One of his/her strongest points is ...

His/Her best quality is ...

What impresses me about him/her is ...

His/Her biggest asset is ...

One of his/her major weaknesses is ...

I think he/she lacks ...

I'm worried/concerned about his/her age/experience/qualifications ...

What concerns me about the candidate is ...

MEET THE EXPERT

1 EDUCATION AND EMPLOYMENT

1 You are going to watch an interview with Helen Kempster, a careers consultant. Before you watch, work with a partner and discuss the questions.

- 1 In what ways do you think Helen helps people find a job?
- 2 What do you think are the best ways of preparing for a job interview?



2  **1** Watch the interview and number the topics Helen discusses in the order she talks about them.



- a what's important when writing a CV
- b different ways she helps people find a job
- c two main types of interview questions
- d her most important advice for people looking for work
- e how to prepare for an interview



3 Watch the interview again. Are the statements true (T) or false (F)?

- 1 The Careers Group only finds jobs for people who have recently graduated.
- 2 Helen helps create specialised training programmes within academic departments.
- 3 The most important thing for people with little experience is how they look.
- 4 You should create just one CV with all your skills and experience and use this for each job application.
- 5 You should prepare how you are going to answer certain questions in an interview.
- 6 Interview questions are based around what you can offer the company and your reasons for applying for the job.
- 7 Competency-based questions use example situations to test your problem-solving abilities.
- 8 When preparing for an interview, you need to do more than just finding out what the company does.

4a Match the competency-based questions with the skills in the box that they are asking about.

creativity	flexibility	independence
leadership	teamwork	

- 1 Tell us about a situation in which you developed a new way of doing something.
- 2 Tell us about a time when you worked with a group of people to solve a problem.
- 3 Describe a situation in which you had to guide a group of people to success. What did you do to motivate them?
- 4 Describe a situation in which you had to change the way you were doing something. What did you change and how did it improve the situation?
- 5 Tell us about a time when you went against the usual way of doing things. Why did you feel this was necessary?

4b Choose one of the questions in Exercise 4a and prepare your own answer to it.

4c Work with a partner and share your answers.

